

Structural Analysis

Syllable Types

Closed

Open

V-c-e

C-le

R-controlled

Diphthong

Syllabication Rules

vc/cv, v/cv, vc/v, vc/ccv, v/v

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Structural Analysis: Syllables and Syllabication

Students have been learning the sounds and lower level phonetic generalizations of the English language as they embark on their quest to improve literacy skills. As they become successful in decoding and spelling words at this level, many can be now introduced to syllable types and syllabication. For older students and adults, this can be taught earlier when they have covered short vowels and have learned to read/spell words with these patterns. However, the teachers need to assess their students before making the decision to teach structural analysis at this time.

The study of syllabication begins with the introduction of the concept of syllable. Students need to be taught that a syllable can be a single vowel, a “small” word or part of a longer word. They also should know that there are as many syllables as there are vowel sounds (note: “u” is never counted as a vowel when it follows a “q”). The following are some activities that a teacher may use for introducing syllables:

1. Syllables can be described as a push of the breath. Demonstrate by pronouncing the following words with the palm facing the mouth (“feel the push of the air”) - ten, pamper, chin, table, chair, staple, ham, candy, pencil, and thimble. *Be careful in the selection of the words as the student may not feel this push of the air for some of them.
2. Students can clap out or “pound out” syllables in words and note the number of syllables. The teacher may use students’ names or the following words for this activity:

John Steven Rebecca Sam Derek Michael Nancy Peter

Atlantic badminton basketball rugby soccer book cover

truck Boston Massachusetts Florida China Montana computer

ship picnic gymnastics fantastic football shack magnet

After these preliminary activities, the teacher begins instruction in the first type of syllable - closed syllable. Subsequently, the teacher will introduce the first syllabication rule - vc/cv. The teacher may use the following scope and sequence:

closed syllable ----- vc/cv ----- vowel-consonant-e syllable ----- vc/cv-c-e -----

vc/cy ----- open syllable ----- v/cv, v/cv-c-e, v/cy ----- consonant-le syllable ----
y = /ē/

--- vc/c-le, v/c-le ----- vc/v ----- r-controlled syllable/division* ----- vc/ccv ----- tion/sion ---

diphthong syllable/division ----- compound words* ----- prefix/root/suffix -----

v/v ----- Crazy “i” and connectives

There is some flexibility in what the teacher decides to work on relative to this scope and sequence. See asterisks.

Materials in this volume include worksheets on the different syllable types and rules of syllabication. There are also activities on analogies and vocabulary, crossword puzzles, and bingo and tic-tac-toe games. Additionally, there are visual analysis activities whereby students determine which word in a series does not belong relative to a particular syllabication pattern. These worksheets provide reinforcement of the concepts covered as well as integrate vocabulary development, analogies, and thinking skills (e.g., categorizing). The following may be helpful to the teacher:

1. When introducing a syllable type or new syllabication division rule, the teacher may want to write the words on the board, overhead transparency or chart paper for demonstration purposes.
2. Students can use a raised dot or slash to show the division of a word into syllables. The slash can be confusing as it resembles a "1."
3. When doing a whole group a lesson, have students divide each word and pronounce rather than dividing all of the words first and then returning to pronounce them.
4. After the dividing the word, the student should pronounce the first syllable, then the second syllable, and subsequently the whole word.
5. Note to students that one cannot divide between consonant digraphs.
6. Encourage students not to pronounce the words until they have completed the steps - underlining the vowels, labeling the letters, dividing the word, and placing the breve or macron. After some practice, the teacher can drop some of the steps' gradually.
7. Remind students that "u" after a "q" is not considered a vowel.
8. Sheets are available for dictation of multi-syllabic words. The following steps may be helpful:
 - a. Teacher gives each student the spelling form
 - b. Teacher says word and the students repeat.
 - c. Teacher asks for the first syllable - students name it.
 - d. Student then spells the first syllable (saying the sounds as he writes).
*Students can fingerspell the sounds first before writing.
 - e. Teacher repeats the word and asks for the second syllable. Students names the syllable.
 - f. Student writes the second syllable and sounds the letters as he writes.
 - g. Student resynthesizes the word by writing the whole word.

rab + bit = rabbit

As with the sound layer, this level should be taught systematically and sequentially. Give as much practice as needed. Additionally, when students are engaged in oral reading and come to a multisyllabic word that they do not know, encourage them to divide the word utilizing the syllabication rules that they have previously learned.

Structured Spelling for Syllabication

Name: _____

1st Syllable

2nd Syllable

Whole Word

+

=

+

=

+

=

+

=

+

=

+

=

+

=

+

=

Structured Spelling for Syllabication

Name: _____

1st Syllable

2nd Syllable

Whole Word

+ =

+ =

+ =

+ + =

+ + =

+ + =

+ + =

+ + =

SCOPE AND SEQUENCE: LANGUAGE STRUCTURES

by Ron Yoshimoto

PHONOLOGY (SOUNDS)	Phonemic Awareness -----> Letter Recognition -----> Consonant digraphs ---> Letter Combinations ("q" is always followed by "u") Handwriting Basic Sound/Symbol (a, t, b, l, f, h, p, s, u, m, r, c, w, g, y, v, i, n, d, j, z, qu, o, k, e, x) (no English words end in a "v"/"i") -ck/-dge/-tch -> vowel-consonant-e -> Vowel Digraphs-R-controlled -> Vowel Digraphs, etc. (higher) - --> Advanced (-ed) ("s" saying /z/ (all) (-ld, -nd, -st) (Lower Level) (oi, oy, ar, ee, or, ai, ay, er, igh, oa, "y" = / i /, oo, ea, ou, ow, kn, ir, au, aw, oe, ew, eigh) (Soft/hard "c"/"g") (-ture*, ur, -tion*, -age*, -sion*, ie, ue, ph, -stle*, ey*, ough, wr, -ckle*, -cket*, ui, or = /er/*, augh, ei*, gn eu, ar = /er/*, ch = /k/ or /sh/, ear, qua, y = / i /, our*, -que*, -gue*, wor, gh*, alk/alt, -mb, wa, rh, -mn, war, a = / ə /, y = /i/ in long words*) <i>**1-1-1, Silent-e, and Y to i introduced after teaching some suffixes.</i>
STRUCTURAL ANALYSIS SYLLABICATION	Closed syllable -----> vc/cv -----> vowel-consonant-e syllable -----> vc/cv-c-e>>> vc/cy ----> open syllable -> <i>*(teach after short vowels)</i> y = /ē/ v/cv, v/c-y-c-e, v/cy ----> consonant-le syllable -----> vc/c-le, v/c-le ----> vc/v ----> r-controlled syllable/division* ----> vc/ccv -----> -tion/-sion -----> diphthong syllable/division ---> compound words* -----> prefix/root/suffix** ----> v/v -----> Crazy "i" and connectives <i>*May be taught earlier</i> <i>**See Morphology</i>
MORPHOLOGY (LATIN)	Closed prefixes (un, ex, in, mis, con, etc.) -----> open prefixes (re, pre, pro, de, etc.) ----> introduce roots -----> (introduce after closed syllables) (after introducing open syllable) (after teaching some affixes) Lower level suffixes (-ed, -er, -est, -ing, -ful, -ly, etc.) Continue introducing prefixes/suffixes/roots -----> chameleon prefixes -----> Similar-sounding suffixes closed - open syllable changes (-est/ist, -es/-ous, -able/-ible)